climate cli · mate

Definition

noun

1. the usual weather conditions in a place.

   Alaska has a cold climate.

Advanced Definition

noun

1. the weather conditions most prevailing in a place, averaged over several years.

   Antarctica has a cold climate.

2. a region defined by generally similar weather conditions.

   We will vacation in a tropical climate this winter.

3. the emotional, political, or social conditions prevailing in a place, time, or situation.

   a climate of fear and despair

Spanish cognate

clima: The Spanish word *clima* means climate.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. It is believed that the success of human hunters was a large part of why the mammoth became extinct. Another reason had to do with the climate. The Ice Age did not last forever.
2. Where can you find more animal species than anywhere else in the world? It's not a zoo or the circus. It's a very special type of ecosystem called a rainforest, and most can be found in tropical climates in the Southern Hemisphere.
3. Wild penguins are found only in the southern hemisphere. Most live within the polar region around Antarctica; however, some species of penguins live in the warmer climates of South Africa, New Zealand, and South America.
4. The origins of that corner-store chocolate bar start in fields along the Equator, in countries in South America, Africa, and South Asia. Cocoa comes from the seeds of cacao trees, which thrive in hot, humid climates.
5. Though pollution and human interference are both problems, many scientists consider climate change the greatest threat to the Great Barrier Reef. Ocean temperatures are rising, making coral reefs weaker and more susceptible to disease. Rising ocean temperatures also affect the ecosystems in the coral reef, throwing off the delicate balance that allows so many species to coexist.
6. To protect life in the Arctic, scientists say people need to limit their use of fossil fuels. "Climate change is not just about the

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future," said scientist Pal Prestud, who worked on the report. "It is happening now."

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